

EECE7352 Computer Architecture

Homework 1

Sakthivel P. Sivakumar

NUID: 002312294

Part B:

Linpack Benchmark

The LINPACK benchmark is designed to measure the **floating-point performance** of a system by solving a dense system of linear equations using LU factorization. It is particularly sensitive to compiler optimizations, math libraries, and the efficiency of floating-point extensions such as SSE/AVX on x86-64.

```
lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O0_out.txt X
PartB > runs > lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O0_out.txt
1 22 September 2025 08:27:47 PM
2
3 LINPACK_BENCH
4 C version
5
6 The LINPACK benchmark.
7 Language: C
8 Datatype: Double precision real
9 Matrix order N = 1000
10 Leading matrix dimension LDA = 1001
11
12 Norm. Resid Resid MACHEP X[1] X[N]
13 6.491510 0.000000 2.220446e-16 1.000000 1.000000
14
15 Factor Solve Total MFLOPS Unit Cray-Ratio
16 1.205946 0.003697 1.209643 552.780173 0.003618 21.600768
17
18 LINPACK_BENCH
19 Normal end of execution.
20
21 22 September 2025 08:27:48 PM
22
23
24

lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O1_out.txt X
PartB > runs > lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O1_out.txt
1 22 September 2025 08:28:15 PM
2
3 LINPACK_BENCH
4 C version
5
6 The LINPACK benchmark.
7 Language: C
8 Datatype: Double precision real
9 Matrix order N = 1000
10 Leading matrix dimension LDA = 1001
11
12 Norm. Resid Resid MACHEP X[1] X[N]
13 6.491510 0.000000 2.220446e-16 1.000000 1.000000
14
15 Factor Solve Total MFLOPS Unit Cray-Ratio
16 0.308207 0.000846 0.309053 2163.598692 0.000924 5.518804
17
18 LINPACK_BENCH
19 Normal end of execution.
20
21 22 September 2025 08:28:16 PM
22
23
24
```

```
lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O2_out.txt X
PartB > runs > lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O2_out.txt
1 22 September 2025 08:29:21 PM
2
3 LINPACK_BENCH
4 C version
5
6 The LINPACK benchmark.
7 Language: C
8 Datatype: Double precision real
9 Matrix order N = 1000
10 Leading matrix dimension LDA = 1001
11
12 Norm. Resid Resid MACHEP X[1] X[N]
13 6.491510 0.000000 2.220446e-16 1.000000 1.000000
14
15 Factor Solve Total MFLOPS Unit Cray-Ratio
16 0.306617 0.000840 0.307457 2174.829868 0.000920 5.490304
17
18 LINPACK_BENCH
19 Normal end of execution.
20
21 22 September 2025 08:29:21 PM
22
23
24

lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O3_out.txt X
PartB > runs > lota.coe.neu.edu.gcc_O3_out.txt
1 22 September 2025 08:29:47 PM
2
3 LINPACK_BENCH
4 C version
5
6 The LINPACK benchmark.
7 Language: C
8 Datatype: Double precision real
9 Matrix order N = 1000
10 Leading matrix dimension LDA = 1001
11
12 Norm. Resid Resid MACHEP X[1] X[N]
13 6.491510 0.000000 2.220446e-16 1.000000 1.000000
14
15 Factor Solve Total MFLOPS Unit Cray-Ratio
16 0.232429 0.000619 0.233048 2869.222935 0.000697 4.161571
17
18 LINPACK_BENCH
19 Normal end of execution.
20
21 22 September 2025 08:29:47 PM
22
23
24

PROBLEMS OUTPUT DEBUG CONSOLE TERMINAL PORTS
sakthivelps@degrees:~/EECE7352/sakthivel/HW1/PartA/ARM_V8/gcc/profiles$
```

Table:

A	B	C	D	E	F	G
Optimization	Factor (s)	Solve (s)	Total (s)	MFLOPS	Cray-Ratio	
O0	1.205946	0.003697	1.209643	552.780173	21.600768	
O1	0.308207	0.000846	0.309053	2163.598692	5.518804	
O2	0.306617	0.00084	0.307457	2174.829868	5.490304	
O3	0.232429	0.000619	0.233048	2869.222935	4.161571	

Metrics reported in the Benchmark

The benchmark reports several metrics:

- **X[1], X[N]:** spot checks of the solution vector for sanity validation.
- **Factor, Solve, Total times:** timing components. *Factor* is the LU decomposition stage, *Solve* is the forward/back substitution, and *Total* is the combined execution time.
- **MFLOPS (Millions of Floating-Point Operations per Second):** the **primary performance metric**. It reflects how quickly the CPU executed the floating-point operations for the chosen matrix size.
- **Cray Ratio:** a historical metric comparing performance against a Cray baseline system.

From the results collected across different -O levels, the impact of compiler optimizations is clear. At **-O0**, performance is very low (~ **553 MFLOPS**). Moving to **-O1** and **-O2**, the MFLOPS rises sharply into the thousands (~2,100 MFLOPS at -O2), showing the benefits of instruction scheduling and partial vectorization. At **-O3**, the compiler fully leverages loop unrolling, inlining, and SIMD instructions, pushing throughput to nearly **2,900 MFLOPS**. This is a more than **5X improvement** compared to the unoptimized build.

In summary, LINPACK is not just a measure of raw clock speed but of the system’s ability to sustain **floating-point intensive workloads** using optimized code paths and vectorized math instructions. The benchmark demonstrates how crucial compiler optimizations are for unlocking the real floating-point potential of modern x86-64 hardware.